

Tasin Academy

Opposite to Alekanda Govt College, Barishal

Phone: 01722335722

While Leela Nag made headlines during the 1947 Partition, **Nadera Begum**, another student of the Department of English, was making headlines in 1949. Coming from an affluent political family, Nadera Begum was a strong Marxist who was among the leading women rebels of her time. In 1949, she was expelled from the University of Dhaka for fighting for the rights of the fourth-class employees of the University. She was the only woman seen standing near Sheikh Mujibur Rahman during those protests. In Cheman Ara's article entitled 'The Women who broke the barricades' (published in The Daily Star, Feb 21, 2020), it is stated: "Names of Nadera Begum, Hamida Khatun, Nurjahan Murshid, Afsari Nadera Begum was a shining example of the multigenerational feminism that was evident among the women - both students and teachers of the Department of English. This is why, during the tumultuous oppression. Razia Khan Amin, who joined as a faculty member of the department in 1962, showcased her activism through her writing and her cultural interests. She had completed her B.A. and M.A. in English from the Department of English, University of Dhaka, and proceeded to do her M.A. in English from the University of Birmingham on a scholarship from the British Council. She was simultaneously an educationist, a theatre actor, a journalist, a columnist, a poet, and a celebrated writer. Among the prestigious awards she received are the PEN Lay Writing Award (1956), the Pope Gold Medal (1957), Bangla Academy Literary Award (1975), Ekushey Padak (1997), and the Anannya Literature Award (2003).

Amin exposes the brutality of the 1971 Liberation War through stark images in her poems. In her poem, 'Argus Under Anaesthesia', she writes:

"A mother frenzied by the roar of mortars
Throttled her whining infant.
Its life for the life of millions."

In yet another poem, 'God in the Goblet', a melancholic tone addresses all the martyrs and the intellectuals who were mercilessly killed in 1971. References to names address the sacrifices of scholars of Bangladesh. Being a scholar herself, Amin had a unique approach to depicting against child marriage and sexual oppression.

1.A. Choose the correct answer from the alternatives:

(10x0.5=5)

(a) The term 'Marxist' refers to ____

- (i) a follower of Adam Smith (ii) a follower of Vladimir Lenin
(iii) a follower of Karl Marx (iv) a follower of Mahatma Gandhi

(b) The word 'expose' in the context of Razia Khan Amin's poems suggests ____

- (i) to reveal something hidden (ii) to hide something precious
(iii) to conceal something valuable (iv) to veil something important

(c) What is the closest synonym of 'expelled'?

- (i) invited (ii) accepted (iii) promoted (iv) discharged

(d) 'The Women who broke the barricades' is ____

- (i) a book (ii) an article (iii) a play (iv) a historical event

(e) The author suggests that the women of the Department of English were involved in ____

- (i) literary works (ii) political movements (iii) cultural activities (iv) all of the above

f) The term 'Marxist' refers to ____

- (i) a follower of Adam Smith (ii) a follower of Vladimir Lenin
(iii) a follower of Karl Marx (iv) a follower of Mahatma Gandhi

g) The word 'expose' in the context of Razia Khan Amin's poems suggests ____

- (i) to reveal something hidden (ii) to hide something precious
(iii) to conceal something valuable (iv) to veil something important

h) What is the closest synonym of 'expelled'?

- (i) invited (ii) accepted (iii) promoted (iv) discharged

i) 'The Women who broke the barricades' is ____

- (i) a book (ii) an article (iii) a play (iv) a historical event

j) The author suggests that the women of the Department of English were involved in..

- (i) literary works (ii) political movements (iii) cultural activities (iv) all of the above

1.B. Answer the following questions: (5x2=10)

(a) Who was Nadera Begum and what was she known for during the 1949 protests at the University of Dhaka?

(b) Which women besides Nadera Begum played significant roles in the history of the Language Movement according to Cheman Ara's article?

(c) What distinguished Razia Khan Amin, a faculty member of the University of Dhaka's Department of English in the 1960s?

(d) What impactful events are highlighted in Razia Khan Amin's poems during the 1971 Liberation War?

(e) How did Razia Khan Amin use her position as a scholar to address social issues affecting women in her poem "The Old Man and the Girl"?

2. Read the passage and complete the table below with the given information. 1x10=10

What/Who	Event/Activity	Where/Place	When/How/Why
Nadera Begum	(i).....	Department of English, DU	(ii).....
She	(iii).....	Bengal	
She	was a strong Marxist rebel		(iv).....
(v).....	was expelled	(vi).....	for supporting the rights of employees
She	fought for the rights of fourth-class employees	(vii).....	(viii).....
She	Was a shining example of multigenerational feminism	(ix).....	(x).....

Or,

Read the above passage and make a flowchart showing the struggling life of Nadera Begum (One is done for you.) 2x5=10

1. Making Headlines	→	2	→	3	→	4	→	5	→	6
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3. Summary Writing

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Write a summary of the passage in your own words.